

Digitisation of land records in progress

8,13,891 applications received on pending land matters were settled within seven months

will have his or her computer. In addition to the computers already in use, another 1,700 computers will be purchased. The project is expected to be replicated in the district and subdivisional offices in future.

The most impactful digital initiative of Assam has been the Mission Basundhara under the aegis of Revenue and Disaster Management Department. The first phase of the mission, launched on October 2, 2021, is a decisive step towards streamlining land revenue services and records, facilitating easy access to the public for their land-related work, reducing the pendency in update of land records and eliminating middle men from the land management ecosystem. With an outlay of Rs 225 crore, this mission will ensure that land records in the state are completely digitalised by December 2023.

The pet project of the chief minister also includes conducting a detailed survey of non-cadastral villages—where no survey has been conducted till date. A large section of the indigenous people, especially the poor and disadvantaged ones, have lost grip over land in the state as they fail to access land records in government offices. Their ancestral lands have been taken away by illegal immigrants from Bangladesh who often forge documents with help of middlemen.

The chief minister's intent of cleaning up the entire process was evident from the beginning. Even before the launch of the mission, nearly 700 land brokers were arrested across the state. "The mission aims to eliminate the middleman from the system and reduce unnecessary visits to government offices, while empowering the public to resolve land-related issues online in a hassle-free manner," says Sarma.

The Mission Basundhara portal, supported by Integrated Land Records Management System (ILRMS)—the integrated software for disposing cases—provides nine land revenue services. Between October 2, 2021, and December 7, 2021—the time window given to file applications— 8,13,891 applications were received on pending matters related to land records, and these were settled by May 8, 2022, the deadline set for resolution of these cases.

The applications received and service wise disposal of cases were monitored through the dashboard incorporated in the portal. Applicants could track the real time status of application and service delivery. Through Integrity Helpline of Mission Basundhara, people could lodge complaints and obtain clarity on process related queries. This two-way communication helped people by expediting resolution of grievances faced during service delivery. The second phase of the mission will begin in October 2022.

> For nearly two decades, our family had been trying for mutation of a plot of land which was in the name of my deceased husband. I then applied through Mission Basundhara. Within three months, I got the mutation certificate."
>
> ***Basanti Das, Niz Sindurighopa, North Guwahati Revenue Circle, Kamrup (rural) district***

> I had applied for a periodic patta to be allotted to me. Within a month of application, I got my job done without making any round to government offices. Mission Basundhara changed my perception about government work."
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> ***Phandidhar Phukan, Bhajoni, Tengakhat Revenue Circle, Dibugarh***

A PING CAN CLEAR ROAD BLOCK

Around 95 per cent complaints received through social media platforms such as Facebook, Twitter and Instagram have been addressed

- No of grievances received: 5,049
- No of grievances solved: 4,791

